

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



INDIA - WEST ASIA - 2

MODULE - 42

POLITICAL

India and United Arab Emirates (UAE) established diplomatic relations in 1972.

1 During PM Modi's visit to UAE in 2018, several agreements were signed:

- MoU between Government of India and Government of UAE for cooperation in the field of Manpower.
- MoU between Ministry of Railways, India and Federal Transport Authority - Land & Maritime of UAE for Technical Cooperation in Rail Sector.
- MoU between Government of Jammu and Kashmir and DP World FZE for development of Multi modal logistics hub in J&K.

2 The visit of Indian PM to UAE in 2015 transformed the relationship between India and UAE is of a comprehensive strategic partnership. It is a reflection of the growing importance India is giving to the UAE.



ECONOMIC

India-UAE commercial relations are driven by energy cooperation, trade, investments by UAE in India and investments & businesses driven by Indian expatriates in UAE.

1. ENERGY

- 1 UAE is a key source of energy. UAE was the first contributor to Indian Strategic petroleum reserve.
- 2 In the energy sector, UAE accounts for 8 percent of India's oil imports and is the fifth largest supplier of crude oil to India. Both the countries have speeded up the relationship to transform from what used to be a buyer-seller relationship into strategic partnership.



ECONOMIC

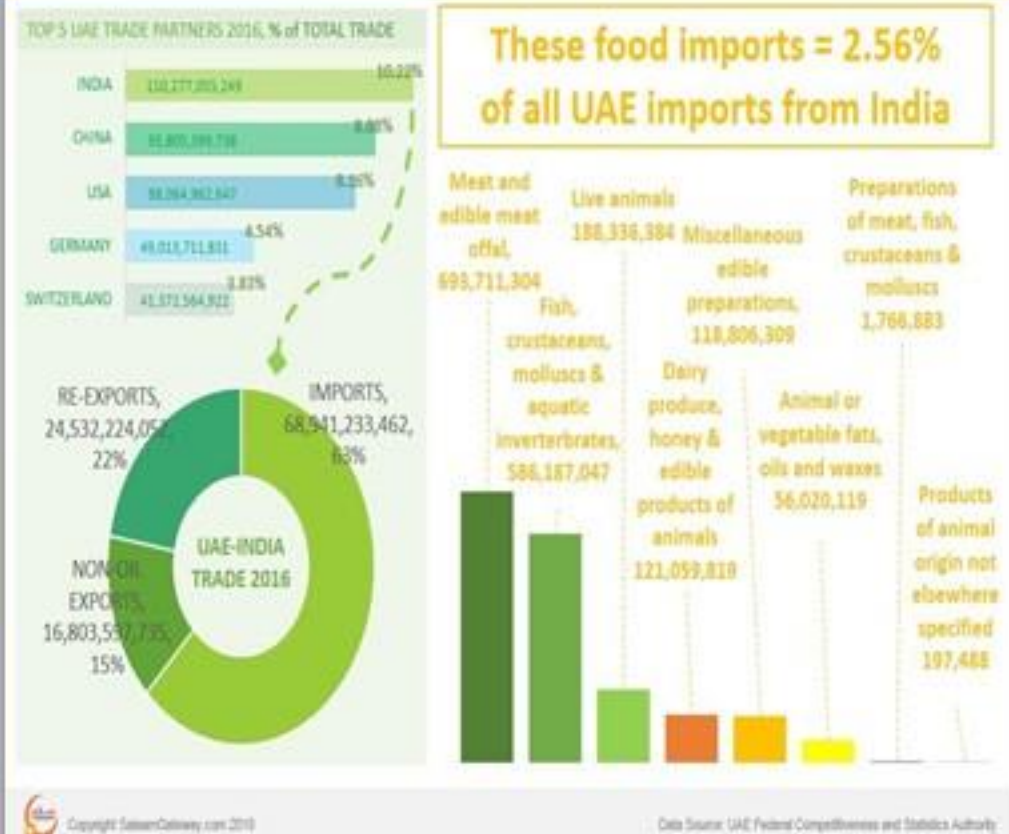
2. BILATERAL TRADE

1 In 2014-2015, trade between India and the UAE crossed \$59 billion with the balance of trade in favour of India, making the UAE one of India's biggest trading partners.

2 India's major export items to the UAE are: Petroleum Products, Precious Metals, Stones, Gems & Jewellery, Minerals, Food Items (Cereals, Sugar, Fruits & Vegetables, Tea, Meat, and Seafood), Textiles

3 India's major import items from the UAE are: Petroleum and Petroleum Products, Precious Metals, Stones, Gems & Jewellery, Minerals, Chemicals, Wood & Wood Products.

UAE – INDIA TRADE 2016 in AED



ECONOMIC

3. INVESTMENTS

1 UAE is the tenth biggest investor in India in terms of FDI.

2 There is an estimated US\$ 8 billion UAE investments in India.

3 UAE's investments in India are concentrated mainly in five sectors: Services Sector (9.44%), Power (8.97%), Construction Development: Townships, Housing, Built-Up Infrastructure and Construction-Development Projects (8.81%), Air Transport (Including Air Freight) (7.42%), Hotel & Tourism (7.29%).

4 In 2018, to facilitate investments and resolve issues relating to UAE Investments in India, a special UAE desk 'UAE PLUS' is being established in Invest India.

BIG DREAMS

₹40,000 crore

NIIF's* initial corpus

\$75 billion

Envisaged long-term investment in India under the proposed UAE-India Infra Investment Fund

₹20,000 crore

Indian government to put in NIIF to hold 49% equity

₹4 lakh crore

NIIF could raise debt up to 10 times

FDI in equity from UAE
(in \$ million)



* April-Sept, #Cumulative FDI (from April 2000 to September 2016)

Note: UAE accounted for roughly 1% of India's cumulative FDI in equity, which also includes inflows under the NRI scheme of the RBI

*National Investment and Infrastructure Fund

SECURITY

- 1 The UAE has increased its security cooperation with India, extraditing three suspects in relation to the Augusta Westland case.
- 2 They agreed to fight against radicalisation and misuse of religion.
- 3 UAE agreed to work towards Comprehensive Convention on International Terrorism.
- 4 The two leaders agreed to enhance cooperation to strengthen maritime security in the Gulf and the Indian Ocean regions, vital for the security and prosperity of both countries.



SECURITY

- 5 MOU for cooperation in exchange of intelligence related to money laundering, terrorist financing and related crimes.
- 6 The two sides discussed ways and means to further promote cooperation in cyber security, including prevention of use of cyber space for terrorism, radicalization and for disturbing social harmony.



MULTILATERAL COOPERATION

- 1 It also agreed to support India's candidature at the UNSC.
- 2 India's Look West Policy compliments GCC's Look East Policy.
- 3 As a part of climate change mitigation efforts, India and UAE agreed to collaborate at the International Solar Alliance (ISA) and pledged commitment to historical Paris Agreement.



CULTURAL

1 The two nations share historical ties and have maintained regular cultural exchanges both at official and people to people levels.

2 India and UAE signed a Cultural Agreement in 1975.

3 In 2018, India was the 'Guest of Honour' country at the UAE's prestigious annual cultural festival, the Abu Dhabi Festival (ADF), which showcased diverse cultural wealth of India to the World

4 In 2018, 4th International Day of Yoga was celebrated in Abu Dhabi with more 5000 people including prominent members of Indian community and diplomats



CULTURAL

- 5 There are 14 Indian schools in Qatar, offering CBSE curricula to over 30,000 students, most of whom are the children of Indian nationals working in Qatar.
- 6 India and UAE announced to set up a digital museum in Abu Dhabi on the life and message of love, tolerance & humanity of Mahatma Gandhi and Sheikh Zayed.
- 7 India participated in the second National Tolerance Festival was organized in the month of November 2018.



INDIAN COMMUNITY

1 Indian population in UAE has grown to 3.3 million, making it the largest concentration of Indian nationals outside India.

2 India and UAE signed a MoU in the field of Manpower Sourcing in December 2006 and a Protocol to streamline the admission of Indian contract workers by way of an electronic contract registration and validation system was signed on April 4, 2012

3 A comprehensive online web-based 'NRI registration system' has been developed for Indians resident in UAE. '

4 An online web based portal called E-migrate system has been developed for recruitment of Indian workers including Indian nurses from 1st June 2015.





INDIA - ISRAEL

COLD WAR PERIOD

- 1 India recognized the State of Israel in 1950.
- 2 But relations between the two nations were not cordial in the beginning.
- 3 This was because India was a member of NAM and was tilted towards USSR. Israel, on the other hand, was an ally of the US.
- 4 Moreover, Indian Muslims were against having relations with Israel.
- 5 By 1992, with the end of Cold War and collapse of Soviet Union, there was an urgent need for better relations with the sole superpower USA.
- 6 Developing relations with Israel would be an important gesture for closer economic cooperation with USA.



POST COLD WAR PERIOD

1 Since early 1990s, successive Indian governments have been trying to strategically balance India's concern in West Asia- supporting the Palestinian cause, along with fulfilling its national interest and 126 International Relations enhancing defence and commercial ties with Israel.

2 Israel has become a close trusted partner of India. 2017 marked the 25-years of establishment of relations between India and Israel

3 Despite the reactions following India's nuclear tests of 1998, Israel helped India during the Kargil War of 1999 against Pakistan by providing Pakistan's positions during the war.



MUTUALLY BENEFICIAL RELATIONSHIP

1 India is geopolitically in an advantageous position and can provide Israel a gateway to South Asia, South-east Asia and East Asia.

2 India feels it has the backing of Israel in managing its interests in South Asia, especially with regards to China and Pakistan.

3 India is a rising power and one of the world's fastest growing economies. It is bound to offer immense opportunities to Israel in terms of a huge market, innovation, science and technology, agriculture and attractive investment destination.

4 Israel, on the other hand, is extremely important for India in matters of defence, dual use technology, dry land, etc.

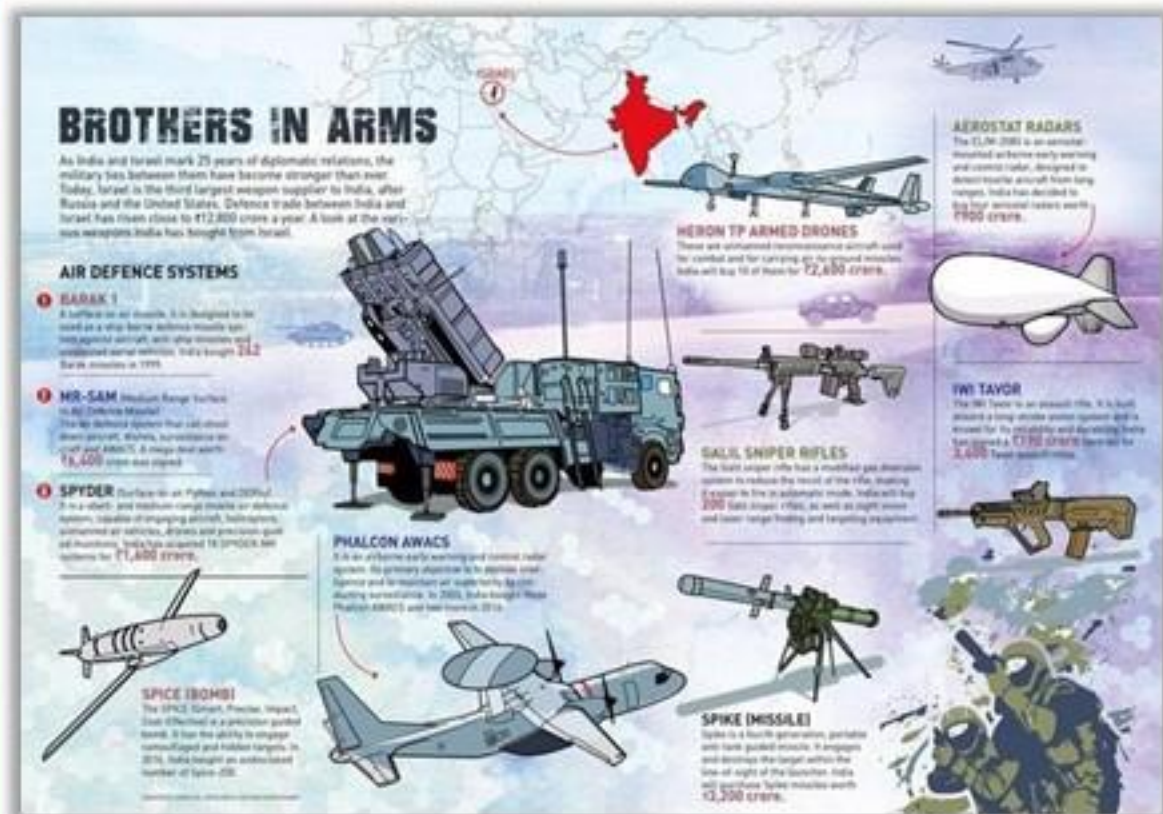


MUTUALLY BENEFICIAL RELATIONSHIP

1. DEFENCE

India has a strong defence relationship with Israel.

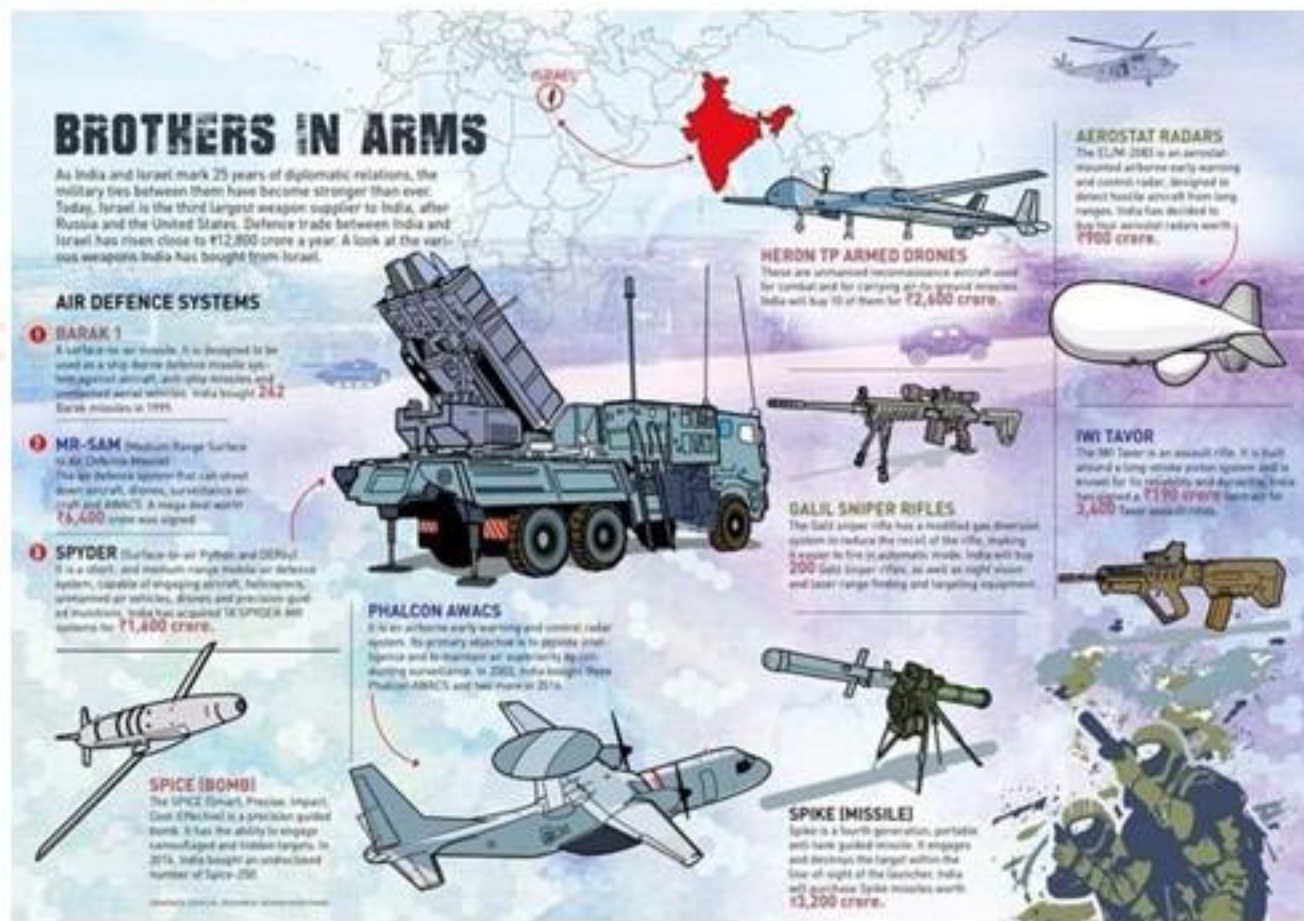
- 1 India bought 41% of Israel's arms exports between 2012 and 2016, making India, Israel's top arms export destination.
- 2 In September 2015 the government approved the Air Force's request to acquire 10 Heron TP drones from Israel Aerospace Industries (IAI) to use for counter insurgency operations
- 3 India has already deployed Israeli unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) in Kashmir and on the disputed border with China for surveillance.



MUTUALLY BENEFICIAL RELATIONSHIP

1. DEFENCE

4 Indian firm Reliance Defence and Israeli firm Rafael Advanced Defence Systems signed a cooperative agreement worth an estimated \$10 billion at Def Expo India on March 30, 2016. It would provide employment for 3,000 Indians at a facility in Madhya Pradesh.



MUTUALLY BENEFICIAL RELATIONSHIP

1. DEFENCE

DEFENCE MANUFACTURING

- 1 Israel also wants to be a key player in the “Make in India” initiative, especially in defence manufacturing through technology transfers and joint research, technology start-ups and cyber security.
- 2 Bharat Forge and Israel Aircraft Industries (IAI) have signed an MoU that covers the establishment of a maintenance centre for selected advanced air defence systems in Hyderabad and Telangana in India.
- 3 Indian and Israeli warships successfully tested the jointly developed Barak 8 long-range surface-to-air missile system during November-December 2015, which will now serve as a missile defence shield for warships and key facilities such as offshore oil platforms.
- 4 It was joint venture of DRDO and Israeli aerospace Industry (IAI).



MUTUALLY BENEFICIAL RELATIONSHIP

2. COUNTER-TERRORISM

- In January 2012, India and Israel stepped up their counter-terrorism coordination strategy.
- The two countries also signed an Extradition Treaty and a pact on Transfer of Sentenced Prisoners.
- Both countries signed an intelligence-sharing agreement in July 2014, hoping to fight radical Islamic extremism in the region together.



MUTUALLY BENEFICIAL RELATIONSHIP

3. AGRICULTURE

- 1** Agriculture has been an important pillar of bilateral relationship.
- 2** India has benefited from Israeli expertise and technology in horticulture mechanisation, protected cultivation, orchard canopy management, nursery management, micro-irrigation and post-harvest management, particularly in Haryana and Maharashtra.
- 3** India extensively uses Israeli drip irrigation technology
- 4** Israeli companies and experts are providing expertise to manage and improve dairy farming in India



MUTUALLY BENEFICIAL RELATIONSHIP

4. RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT

- A Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) was signed for setting up of USD 40 million worth India-Israel Industrial Research and Development (R&D) and Technical Innovation Fund.
- Dynamatic Technologies, IAI and Elcom signed a strategic teaming agreement for industrial cooperation and local production of Unmanned Aerial Systems (UAS) in India.



MUTUALLY BENEFICIAL RELATIONSHIP

5. PEOPLE-TO-PEOPLE CONTACTS

- 1 There are approximately 80,000 Jews of Indian origin in Israel. The majority is from Maharashtra (Bene Israelis) and relatively small numbers from Kerala (Cochini Jews), Kolkata (Baghdadi Jews) and North East (Bnei Menache).
- 2 India is a popular tourist destination of Israelis. Every year, over 40,000 Israelis visit India for tourism and business.
- 3 Both governments also encourage collaboration among universities and educational institutions involving faculty and student exchange program, joint academic research, fellowships, industrial R & D in IT and electronics, promoting innovation, etc.



CONSTRAINTS IN THE RELATIONSHIP

- 1 Lack of bipartisan support in India over ties with Israel is a major stumbling block.
- 2 This is because of Israel's actions against the Palestinian community and support of India's Muslim community for the Palestinian cause
- 3 India's huge reliance on Arab countries and Iran for energy security, diaspora interests, security and connectivity issues force it to have a nuanced approach for ties with Israel so as not to offend these countries.



CONSTRAINTS IN THE RELATIONSHIP

- 4 There is immense potential for collaboration to conduct military exercises especially in the Indian Ocean region and coproduce to reduce cost of arms and ammunition.
- 5 The countries can collaborate in Research and development.
- 6 Despite the critics questioning Indo-Israel relationship diluting India's commitment to the Palestinian cause, India continues to support a sovereign and independent Palestine; alongside strengthening its strategic friendship with Israel.



DEVIATION FROM PALESTINE

- 1 Prime Minister Narendra Modi visited Israel in July 2017 was historic in that it was the first-ever by an Indian Prime Minister.
- 2 The visit did not entail a visit to Palestine, marking a departure from tradition. India has resolved to ease its relations between Palestine and Israel.
- 3 The relationship with Israel is significant as India can benefit a lot from the latter's advanced technologies, particularly in the military domain

- 4 India has never been actively involved in the peace process in Palestine but has always supported it.



DEVIATION FROM PALESTINE

- 5 Palestine has always expected India to play a more active role in the Israel-Palestine negotiations.
- 6 This situation changed in October 2016, when India did not support Palestine in a resolution that questioned Israel's claims.
- 7 The 2018 of the Israeli PM visit to India displayed the success of India's Look-West policy. India intends to de-hyphenate the relation between Israel and Palestine.

- 8 The government has reiterated India's traditional position on a two-state solution, as an independent Palestinian state with East Jerusalem as its capital.



PEACE TO PROSPERITY BY UNITED STATES

- 1** The "Peace to Prosperity: A Vision to Improve the Lives of the Palestinian and Israeli People" popularly known as the Trump peace plan is a proposal by the Trump administration to resolve the Israeli-Palestinian conflict.
- 2** The Trump Administration claims that Peace to Prosperity represents the most ambitious and comprehensive international effort for the Palestinians to date.
- 3** It is a new Marshal Plan that will be implemented over 10 years which will facilitate more than \$50 billion .
- 4** It consists of three initiatives that will support distinct pillars of the Palestinian society: the economy, the people, and the government.



PEACE TO PROSPERITY BY UNITED STATES

CRITICISM OF PEACE TO PROSPERITY

- 1 According to critics, Peace to Prosperity is an American attempt to achieve a Zionist vision in the Palestinian society
- 2 This plan does not guarantee the security of Israeli citizens and deprives the Palestinian people of their basic political rights.
- 3 Granting statehood to the people of Palestine along the pre-1967 border line is an overdue international promise
- 4 The plan is an indication to the Palestinian people that the situation is shifting to a one-Jewish-state solution where the Palestinian people will be discriminated against
- 5 Moreover with President Trump team terming itself as a “facilitator” instead of “mediator.” is an indication that this is a opportunist deal rather than a win/win peace deal



PEACE TO PROSPERITY BY UNITED STATES

INDIA'S REACTION

- 1 PM Modi supported the Palestinian cause. India hopes for an early resumption of talks between Israel and Palestine to move towards a comprehensive and negotiated resolution
- 2 When PM Modi visited Palestine in 2018, India and Palestine two sides had signed agreements worth around USD 50 million. This included the setting up of a USD 30 million super speciality hospital.
- 3 India announced a contribution of USD 5 million to the United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees in the Near East (UNRWA).
- 4 On the International Day of Solidarity with the Palestinian people, PM Modi extended his best wishes to the Palestinian people "in their pursuit of statehood, peace and prosperity."



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